

Two Educator-Focused GenAI Trainings

Microsoft AI for Educators and Google Generative AI for Educators with Gemini

Joshua Plummer · INST 7800 · AI in Education · Module 3: Prompt Engineering for Educators

Proof of Completion

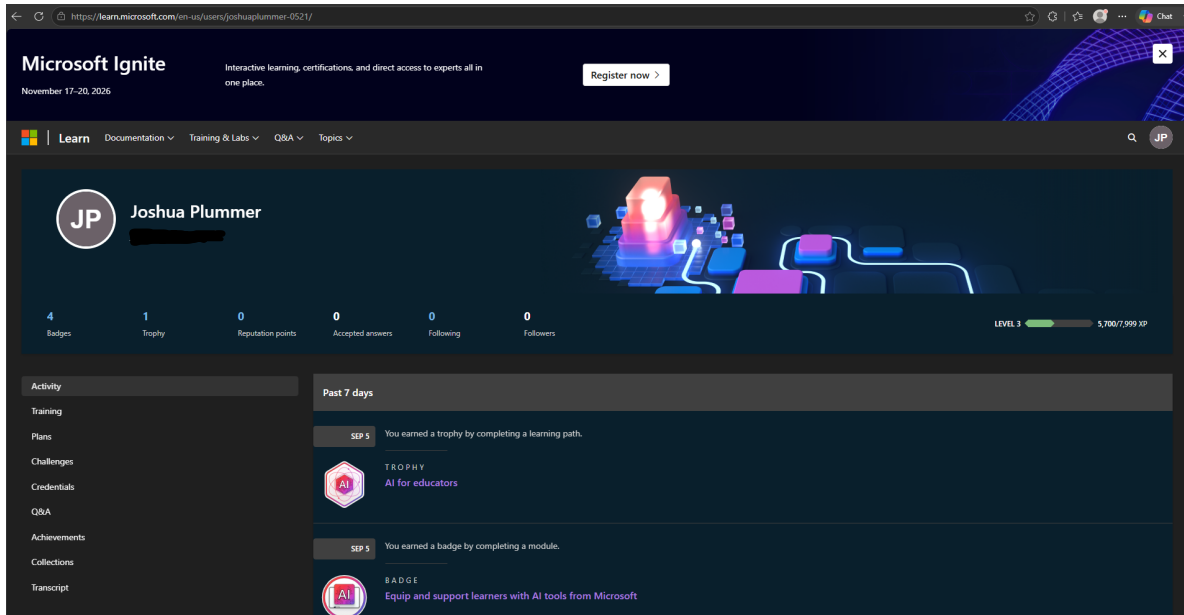


Figure 1: Completion screen, Microsoft *AI for Educators* learning path.

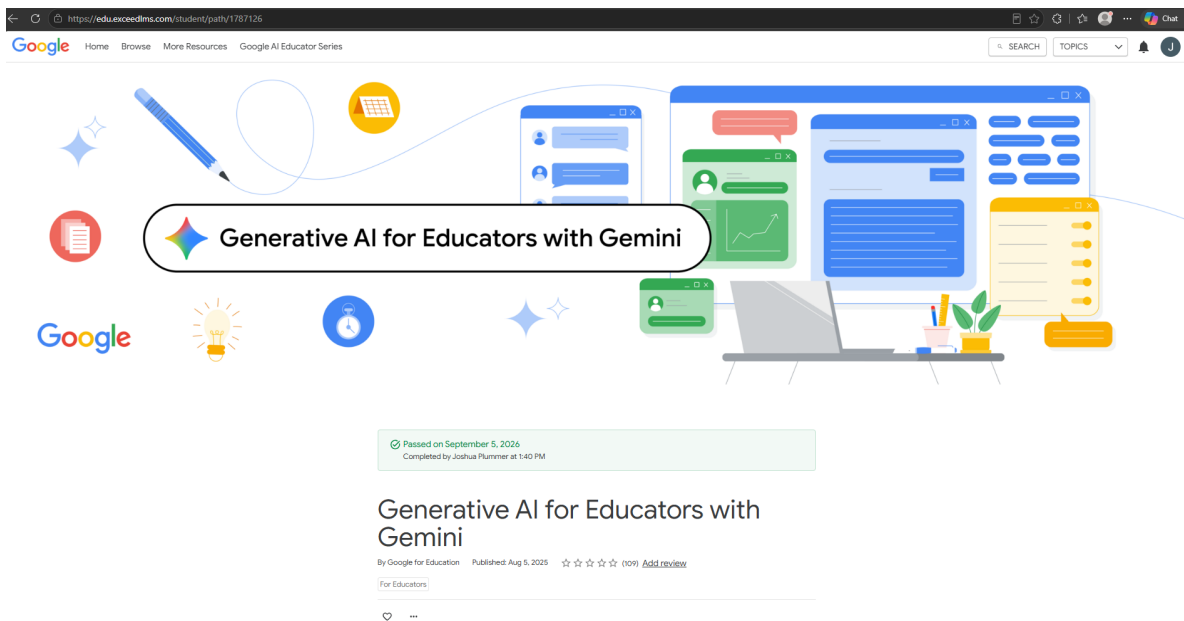


Figure 2: Completion screen, Google *Generative AI for Educators with Gemini*.

Integrated Reflection

The Focus

I completed Microsoft's *AI for Educators* learning path and Google's *Generative AI for Educators with Gemini*. Because AUM runs on the Microsoft suite, I'm already knowledgeable of the app environment and stood to benefit from learning how Copilot integrates into it. This was an easy choice with immediate applications to my teaching and administrative work. I chose the Google course because I am newly experimenting with the Gemini chat bot and Notebook and wanted a structured introduction rather than continue in trial and error. Both learning pathways centered on how their flagship AI can be integrated into everyday tasks such as correspondence, personalized instruction, and lesson planning.

Both are beginner-facing, and a good deal of the content was review for me. Google's course anticipates that directly, noting that familiar concepts can still be "presented in new ways that offer fresh insights." That framing is fair, and it held up. My honest impression is that both courses read as K-12-facing rather than higher-education-facing, though not because they say so: many of their in-context examples were framed around primary and secondary education. But at the same time, this could be subjective due to the beginner-leaning nature of the trainings.

Insights

We learned from this module's required readings that, in the sea of prompt drafting acronyms, each boils down to essentially the same steps (Lee & Palmer, 2025), and this held true for these trainings as well. From previous research, I've found that Google uses the four-part framework: Persona, Task, Context, Format; however, for this training, they teach a five-part prompt anatomy they call PARTS: Persona, Aim, Recipients, Theme, Structure. This is the same framework Park and Choo (2024) built on when they developed IDEA. Because Microsoft's training was more extensive, they bobbed around several approaches depending on context, but at the center of it all are ISTE and UNESCO standards. Their prompt design emphasizes these tips: Define clear objectives, Be specific, Structure the prompt, Iterate and refine, and Combine expertise. After the first round of output, both trainings indicate that the appropriate next step is to run a QA pass before any material reaches students, checking for not only accuracy but bias as well. All together they address how to ask and what to do with the answer once you have it.

Approach to Educational AI

Google teaches portable technique, whereas Microsoft teaches ecosystem and governance. Google's frame will work in Copilot or any other model today or tomorrow. As far as I can tell, Microsoft's value comes from utilizing the current licensing agreement between them and my institution thus integrating AI into their app suite.

Informing the Module 3 Prompt Design

I feel that there's real benefit in applying these principles to my old prompting habits, which is the direction my Module 3 Prompt Engineering Project is heading. My document will illustrate a real prompting sequence in which the opening round named a topic but not the format; instead of receiving a 15-minute quiz in PDF output, the model produced an in-chat interactive widget. I believe the principles of the trainings become clear, because both frameworks placed formatting inside the prompt as opposed to a cleanup exercise.

Application Example

The frameworks presented are apt to be used to create guided notes for my Elementary Statistics course STAT 1070. Guided notes are a partially completed handout that students fill in during lecture, with blanks in the definitions of key terms and within the worked examples. Building them by hand from a slide deck is a slow and laborious process, which is why I have not done it consistently. This is a good candidate for the PARTS framework.

PARTS Prompt

Persona: You are an experienced university mathematics instructor teaching elementary statistics who creates educational materials such as PowerPoint lectures, quick reference guides, skill-check worksheets, and guided notes.

Aim: Convert the attached lecture slides into a guided-notes handout that students complete during a 75-minute class.

Recipients: Many of the students in the course are math-averse and have never taken a rigorous statistics course. They may have neither strong note-taking nor study skills. They are often in a corequisite support course alongside the primary statistics course.

Theme: The attached lecture slides cover Frequency Distributions and are based on Section 2.1 of Mario Triola's Elementary Statistics (14th edition). Vocabulary and notation are likely new for the students, so any blanks should fall on load-bearing terms and notation as well as the steps of each worked example. Edit any conceptual explanations for clarity and conciseness, and report any edits made. Lean into intuitive and approachable language. Otherwise keep all text and images as mirrors of those presented in the slides.

Structure: Use 12pt, highly legible font with 1.5 line spacing. Every blank should have more than adequate space for students to write the correct word or phrase. Examples should provide more than adequate space for complete solutions. Give the document pleasant coloring where appropriate and use an intuitive hierarchical structure for the content. The document should be produced as .DOCX file for easy user edits.